GITHUB COPILOT

Free for students.
Your AI pair programmer.

THE CORE IDEA

GitHub Education gives verified students free access to GitHub Copilot.

In this guide you apply for student benefits, activate Copilot, and install it in your code editor and terminal.

01	02	03	04	05	06
APPLY	WAIT	ACTIVATE	SET UP	INSTALL	BUILD

PLAN AHEAD

Approval can take hours. Benefits can take 72 hours.

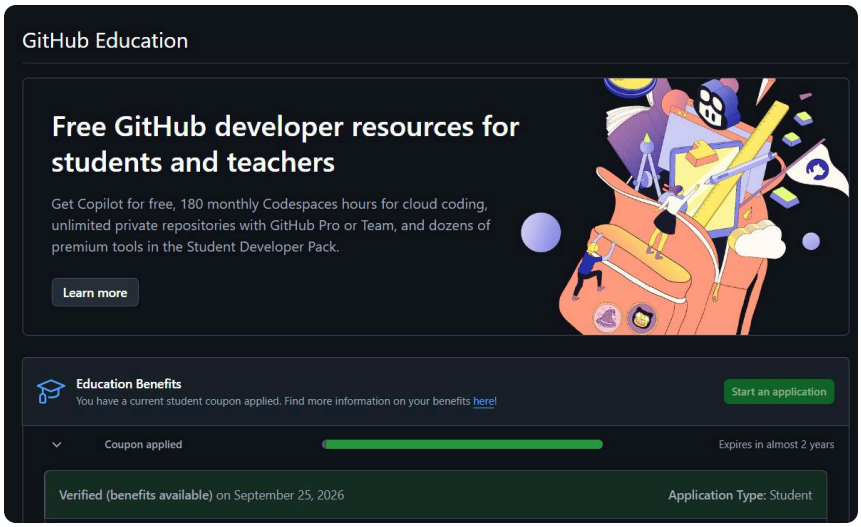
Apply for student benefits

Start today. GitHub has to verify that you are a student.

01

START AN APPLICATION

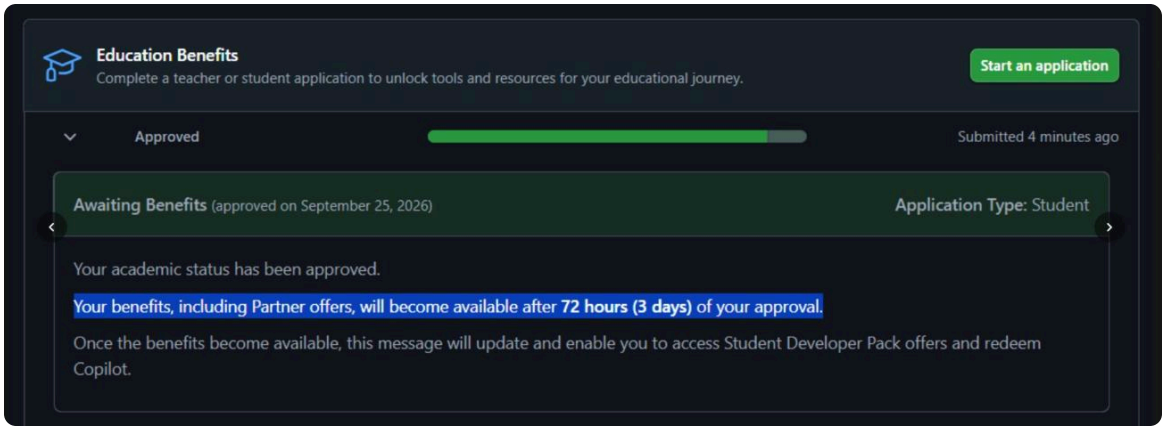
Go to **github.com/education/students**. Sign in to GitHub and select **Start an application**. Upload proof that you are a student when asked.



02

WAIT FOR APPROVAL

Approval can take a few hours. After approval, your benefits can take **up to 72 hours** to become available.



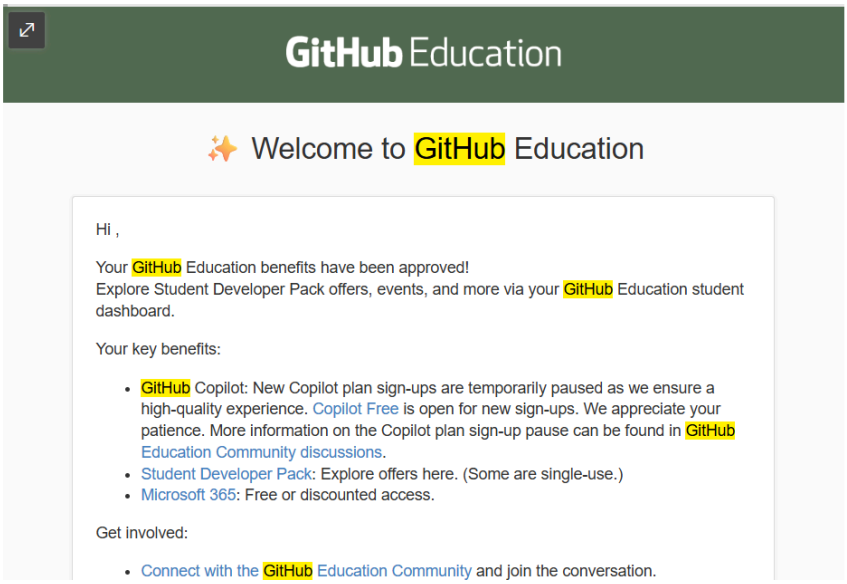
Activate GitHub Copilot

When your benefits are ready, GitHub sends you an email.

03

CHECK YOUR EMAIL

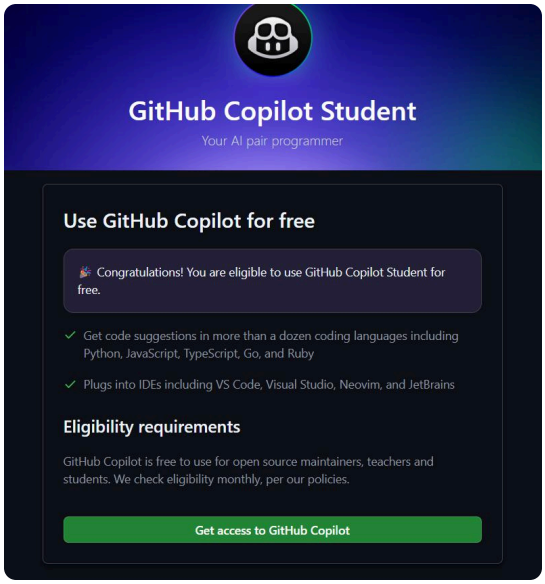
Look for a welcome email from **GitHub Education**. It confirms your benefits are approved.



04

GET ACCESS TO COPILOT

Follow the link to the Copilot page and select **Get access to GitHub Copilot**.



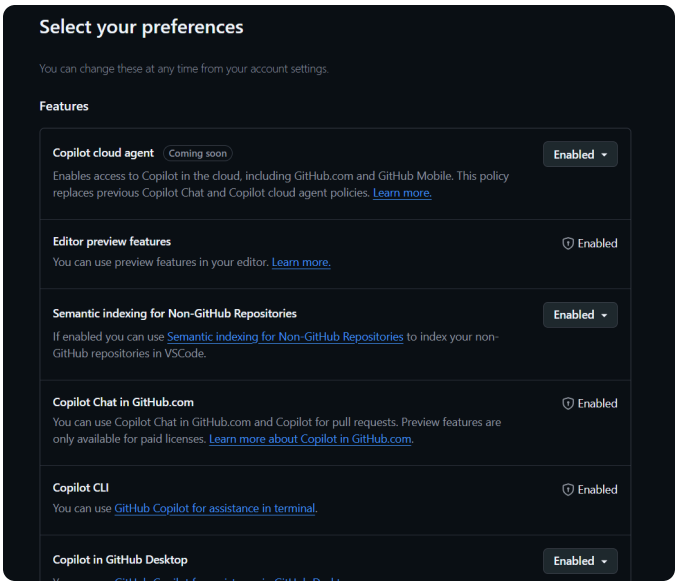
Set your preferences

Choose the Copilot features you want, then install it in your editor.

05

SAVE YOUR PREFERENCES

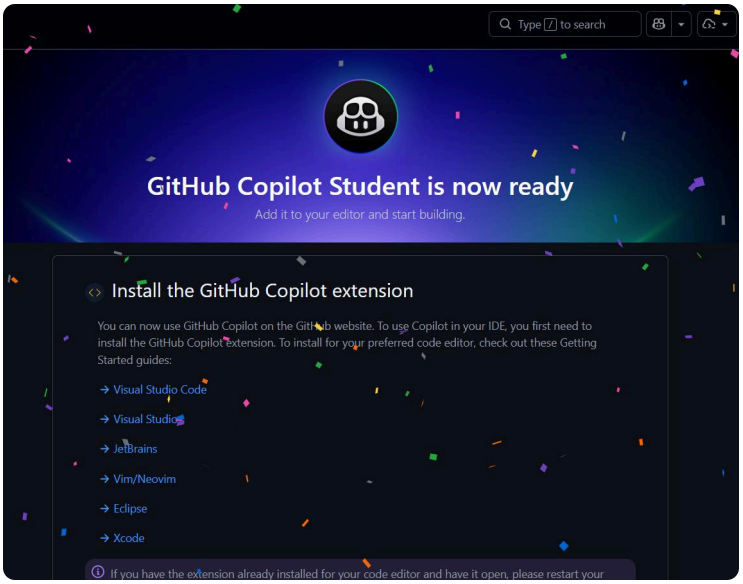
Review the features list. Keep the defaults if you are not sure, then select **Save**.



06

PICK YOUR EDITOR

Copilot is now ready. Choose the guide for your code editor: Visual Studio Code, Visual Studio, JetBrains, and more.



Install Copilot in your editor

Use the editor your team already knows.

07

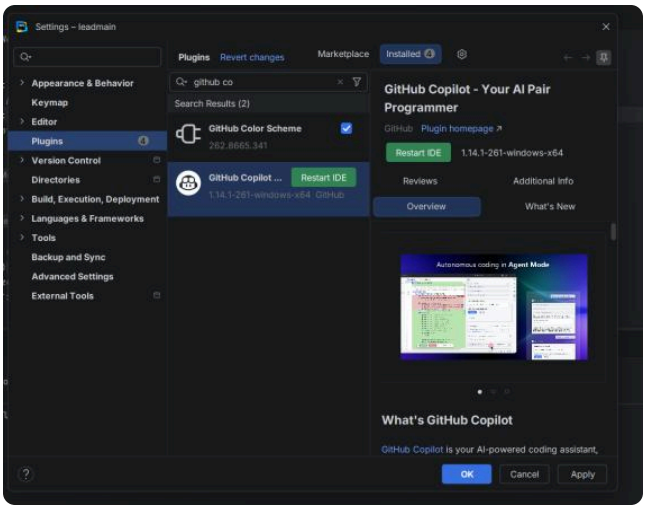
VISUAL STUDIO CODE

Open **Extensions**, search `GitHub Copilot`, and select **Install**. Sign in with your GitHub account when asked.

08

JETBRAINS (EXAMPLE)

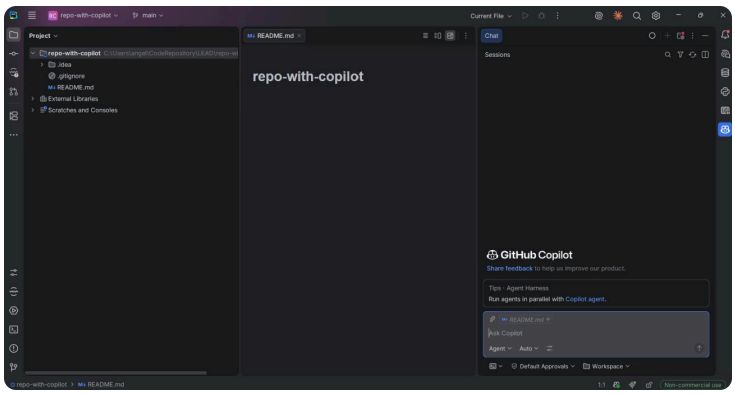
Open **Settings** then **Plugins**. Search `GitHub Copilot`, install it, and restart the IDE.



09

CHAT WITH COPILOT

Open the Copilot chat panel and ask a question about your code.



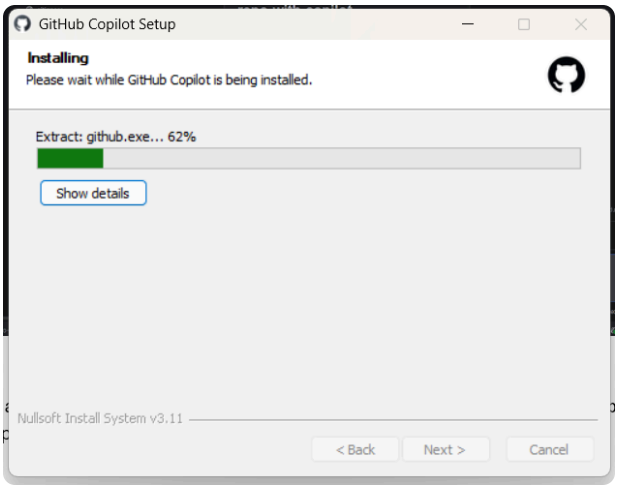
Use Copilot in the terminal

Copilot can also work as an agent from your command line.

10

INSTALL THE COPILOT CLI

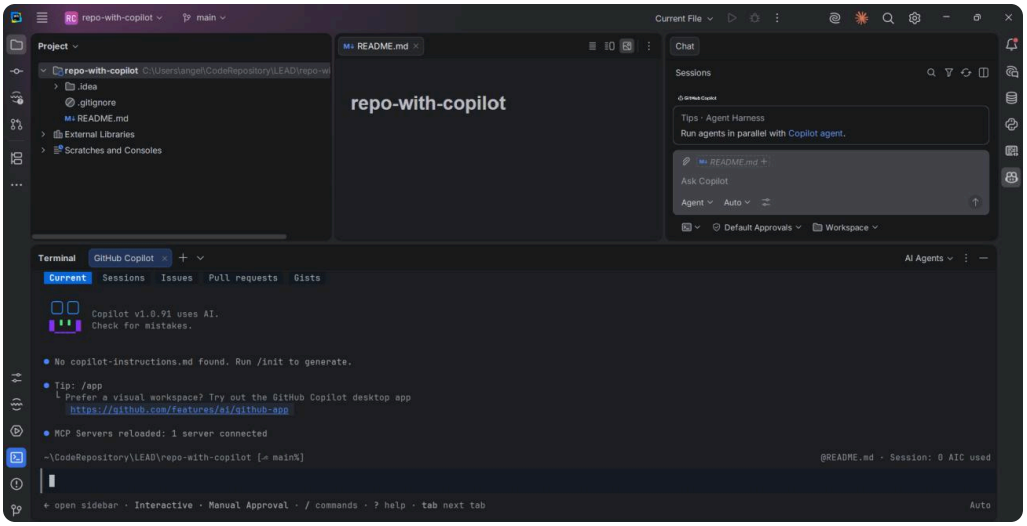
Open the terminal in your IDE and type `copilot`. Follow the instructions to install it. A setup window opens.



11

START WORKING

After setup, send requests to Copilot in the terminal. Start with the command `/init` so Copilot learns your project.



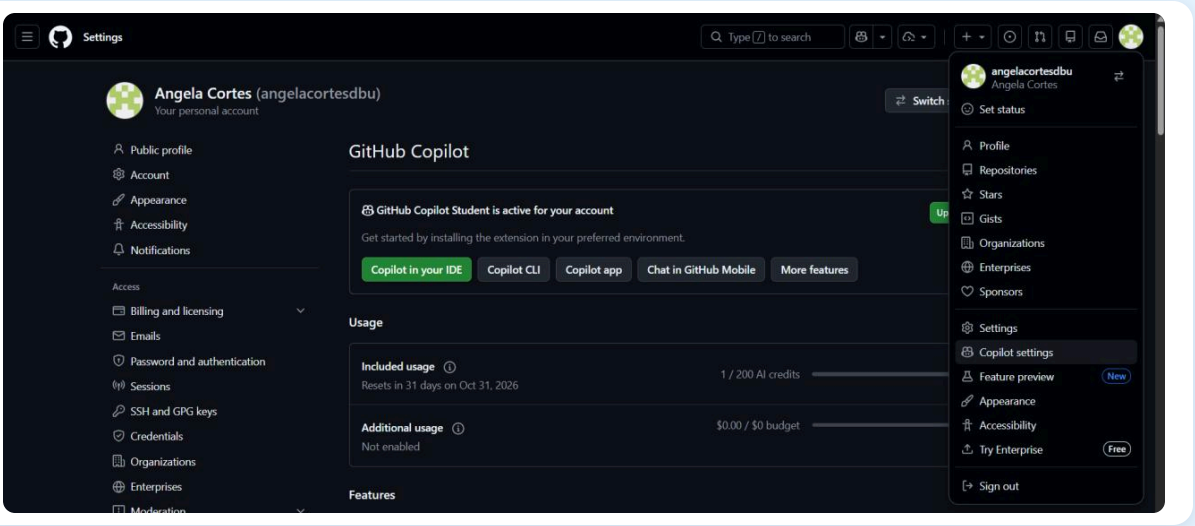
Track your usage

Your Copilot plan includes a monthly amount of usage. Know where you stand.

12

CHECK YOUR USAGE

On github.com, open your profile menu and go to **Settings** then **Copilot**. Review the **Usage** section.



USE AI RESPONSIBLY

Review every suggestion before you keep it.

Never paste secrets, keys, or sensitive data into a prompt. Be ready to explain what Copilot wrote and what your team wrote.

☐	**APPROVED**	My GitHub Education benefits are active.
☐	**INSTALLED**	Copilot works in my editor or terminal.
☐	**USAGE**	I know where to check my monthly usage.